



**BALBIR SINGH  
DHILLON**  
HEAD, AUDI INDIA

**“Luxury EVs are at a pivotal stage in India... [Its] growing base of high-net-worth individuals and the rise of eco-conscious consumers present a unique opportunity for us”**



**VIKRAM PAWAH**  
PRESIDENT, BMW  
INDIA

**“The luxury electric segment in India is seeing very strong interest from young, successful people; 65% of BMW and Mini EV customers are aged below 45”**



**SANTOSH IYER**  
MD & CEO, MERCEDES-  
BENZ INDIA

**“Our digital extras and connectivity features are now integral parts of comfort, convenience, and safety appointments in our vehicles, making them highly individual and desirable”**

dia. According to Iyer, through the ‘Mercedes me’ app, customers can use connected features like geo-fencing, advanced navigation, vehicle stats check, location, and car-to-X communication, amongst other features. “With connected cars, customers are turning their car into a mobile assistant,” says Iyer.

Similarly, for BMW India, technology has become an integral part of its product portfolio. “The latest BMW Operating System 8.5 offers all the possibilities for interaction between occupants and the vehicle—using touch or voice,” says Pawah. That is complemented by the BMW Intelligent Personal Assistant system that adapts to the driver’s individual habits and proactively provides useful tips, he adds.

## OPTIONS APLENTY

Carmakers are pinning hopes on the sizeable Indian market even as they face a slowdown in the global EV market. However, some, like supercar manufacturers, are calibrating their strategies towards EVs. Luxury car manufacturer Porsche, which has Taycan and Macan EVs in the Indian market, has rolled back its EV sales forecast by 2030. It had earlier expected EVs to account for 80% of its sales by 2030, but now sees the transition taking longer. “The transition to electric cars is taking longer than we thought five years ago,” the company said in a statement in July.

There are some fundamental issues carmakers need to solve for EVs to be considered on par with traditional engines. Stephan Winkelmann, President & CEO of Lamborghini, said in an interview this year that while the performance of an EV won’t be an issue, the engine’s sound, which supercar enthusiasts prize, cannot be replicated. Lamborghini currently has two hybrid vehicles in India.

Despite the scepticism and challenges, industry leaders feel the dip in sales is a temporary glitch. According to them, the luxury EV segment, especially, is poised to grow. Many other carmakers share that optimistic outlook, as is evident from the